



ANCHORED INSIDE
COUNSELING SERVICES

GROUNDING TOOLKIT

Five ways to anchor when your nervous system feels overwhelmed

1

Sensory



- Hold a textured stone or other grounding object
- Use a cooling peppermint roller
- Notice small things you can see, hear, touch, smell, or taste
- Splash cold water on your face
- Wrap in a weighted blanket

2

Visualization



- Picture a place that is relaxing or calm
- Imagine a container for difficult feelings
- Write a list of soothing colors or light
- Picture yourself in your future calm
- Visualize a personal team of allies or helpers

3

Movement



- Take a slow, mindful walk
- Stretch your body gently
- Do 10 wall pushes
- Do a gentle back shake
- Shake out tension
- Try rhythmic movement like marching
- or step-touch

4

Companion/Connection



- Call or text someone you trust
- Spend time with a pet
- Call a crisis line
- Join a supportive group
- Connect through eye contact or a kind smile

5

Cognitive Cooling



- Label what you're feeling
- Challenge unhelpful thoughts
- Journal or write out thoughts
- Talk to yourself like a concerned caring friend
- Remind yourself: "This feeling is temporary."

Build Your Personal Kit



SENSORY



VISUALIZATION



MOVEMENT



COMPANION /
CONNECTION



COGNITIVE
COOLING

*Different tools work in different states.
Practice when you're relatively regulated so they're
easier to use when you need them.*